

SCALE COUNTS

Date: 23-12-2025, Publication: [The Times of India](#), Journalist / Agency: , Edition: [Bangalore](#), Supplement: [Bangalore Times](#), Page No:

Summary:

SCALE COUNTS Lower fees expected to boost business even as assets under mgmt rise: Shah MF Margins to Face Pressure; Vol to Compensate: ICICI Pru AMC Prashant Mahesh Mumbai: Mutual fund profitability could come under pressure with the size of assets under management growing, but a fall in unitholders' fees could compensate for this squeeze, said Nimesh Shah, MD and CEO of ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company, whose 10,600 crore Initial Public Offer (IPO) is open for subscription. The issue, which will close on December 16 (Tuesday), was subscribed 2.11 times on Monday-- the second day of the offer. "As the size of the fund grows, margins are coming down, but with TER (total expense ratio) coming down, volumes will grow, and volumes will compensate for margins," said Shah in an interview "Lower charges will increase the probability of beating the index and will make your business more sustainable." According to Shah, the most important financial parameter is operating profit. "Valuation in this industry is best viewed through the lens of operating profit growth," he said. "We have diversified across mutual funds, portfolio management services, alternative investment funds and offshore advisory As the size of the fund grows, margins are coming down, but with TER (total expense ratio) coming down, volumes will grow, and volumes will compensate for margins NIMESH SHAH MD and CEO, ICICI Prudential AMC sorry, each with a different margin profile. The final margin is a mix of these." ICICI Prudential AMC, the country's second mutual fund with assets under management of 10.87 lakh crore, is the sixth in the 50-member strong industry to tap the IPO market. HDFC Mutual, Aditya Birla AMC, UTI, Nippon and Canara Robeco are among the fund houses that have made their stock market debut in recent years The IPO values ICICI Prudential at 1.07 lakh crore. The market cap of HDFC Mutual Fund, the third largest with AUM of 8.8 lakh crore, stood at 1.11 lakh crore "Over the past several years, asset management businesses have grown at healthy rates while requiring minimal incremental capital," said Shah. "Businesses that deliver consistent growth without heavy capital deployment tend to command higher valuation multiples." Prudential Corporation Holdings, the joint venture partner in the company will offload up to 14.41% of ICICI Prudential AMC's equity Since the issue is entirely an offer for sale (OFS) by Prudential, the company will not receive any proceeds from the IPO. Shah said Prudential's decision to sell a stake in the AMC in the IPO has come after remaining invested in the business since 1998. "They are monetising a part of their investment after 27 years and are selling only a portion," he said. ICICI Bank will continue to be the majority shareholder of the firm with a 53% stake in the joint venture, said Shah. BUSINESS STRATEGY ICICI Prudential's focus on hybrid products has made it one of the biggest asset managers in the category Its market share in the hybrid category is around 25% compared to 13.6% in equity assets and 13.6% overall. "Our strength in hybrid and asset allocation-oriented strategies has been built over multiple market cycles by focusing on risk-adjusted returns," said Shah. It is also sharpening its focus on the alternative investment business including equity-focused Portfolio Management Services (PMS), Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), private credit, and office yield funds. Shah said between FY23 and FY25, alternative AUM has registered a compounded annual growth rate of 43.3%. Currently mutual funds account for 93% of its assets while alternatives account for the balance 7%.

[ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund announces change in fund managers of its 2 funds](#)

Date: [16-01-2026](#), Publication: [economictimes.indiatimes.com](#), Journalist / Agency: , Edition: [Internet](#), Supplement: , Page No:

Summary:

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund announces change in fund managers of its 2 funds ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund announces a shift in leadership for its funds. S Naren will transition out of the Dynamic Asset Allocation Active FOF management. Concurrently, expect updates to the Gold ETF, Regular Gold Savings Fund, and Silver ETF Fund of Fund's core attributes. ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has announced change in fund managers of its two funds - ICICI Prudential Business Cycle Fund and ICICI Prudential Dynamic Asset Allocation Active FOF. The changes are effective from January 1, 2026. The fund house informed about these changes through a notice cum addendum. According to the notice cum addendum, ICICI Prudential Dynamic Asset Allocation Active FOF which was previously managed by Sankaran Naren, Dharmesh Kakkad, Manish Bhandia, and Ritesh Lunawat will now be managed by Dharmesh Kakkad, Manish Bhandia, Ritesh Lunawat, and Sharmila D'silva with S Naren no longer part of this team. Other fund - ICICI Prudential Business Cycle Fund which was previously managed by Anish Tawakley, Manish Bhandia, and Manan Tijoriwala will now be managed by Anish Tawakley, Manish Bhandia, Manan Tijoriwala, and Divya Jain. As of November 30, 2025 (last available portfolio), ICICI Prudential Dynamic Asset Allocation Active FOF had an AUM of Rs 28,974 crore and ICICI Prudential Business Cycle Fund had an AUM of Rs 15,708 crore.

[ICICI Pru AMC becomes most valued stock in capital mkt sector Stock closes 19% higher post debut; market cap overtakes HDFC AMC](#)

Date: [16-01-2026](#), Publication: [The Economic Times](#), Journalist / Agency: , Edition: [Mumbai](#), Supplement: , Page No:

Summary:

ICICI Pru AMC becomes most valued stock in capital mkt sector Stock closes 19% higher post debut; market cap overtakes HDFC AMC SAMIE MODAK Mumbai, 19 December Shares of ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company (AMC) surged as much as 23 per cent in their trading debut on Friday, as investors bet on the company as a key beneficiary of the ongoing shift in house- hold savings from traditional assets to equities. The stock touched an intraday high of 2,663, before settling at *2,576, up *411, or 19 per cent, over its issue price of *2,165 per share. At close, ICICI Prudential AMC commanded a market capitalisation of 1.27 trillion, making it the most valued AMC stock in India's capital market sector, overtaking peer HDFC AMC, which is currently valued at 1.14 trillion. The strong listing followed robust demand for the asset manager's 10,602-crore initial public offering, which was sub- scribed nearly 40 times and garnered bids worth about 3 trillion. The issue was entirely an offer for sale by UK-based Prudential Plc ICICI Prudential AMC's joint venture partner. The company had priced its shares at around 40 times its financial year 2025 (FY25) earnings, broadly in line with listed Proud peers such as HDFC AMC and Nippon Life AMC. Analysts, however, said ICICI Prudential AMC merited a valuation premium, given its leadership in active equity assets under management (AUM), superior revenue mix, margins, and return on equity (ROE). "The attractiveness of the AMC industry in general, driven by financialisation as a long-term macro theme, the strong operating performance of ICICI Prudential AMC, and the pricing of the deal at an attractive discount to listed peers make it one of the most compelling IPOS of the year," wrote Himanshu Dugar of Stylus Holdings in an IPO note published on Smartkarma. "We expect a listing pop of 15-20 Strong debut

ICICI Prudential AMC (*) 2,800 2,586.7 2,600 Change A19.5% 2,400 -2,165.0 Issue price 22001 2.000 Dec 19,25 Source Bloomberg Compiled by BS Research Bureau percent as the stock catches up to relative valuations, with further upside as free float increases." Ahead of the IPO, ICICI Bank held a 51 per cent stake in the company, while Prudential owned the remaining 49 per cent. Post listing, Prudential's stake has declined to 35 per cent, taking the combined promoter holding to about 86 per cent. AMCS typically operate asset-light, high-margin businesses, translating into strong profitability metrics. ICICI Prudential AMC reported an ROE of 83 per cent in financial year 2025 (FY25). Net profit stood at 2,650 crore, while AUM surged to about \$9.1 trillion from 26.5 trillion a year earlier. Groww gets Jefferies' 'buy' initiation Shares of Groww operator Billionbrains Garage Ventures jumped 12 per cent on Friday after Jefferies initiated coverage on the investment platform with a 'buy' rating, citing its rapid rise and strong earnings growth visibility. Shares of the company ended at 161, up 17, or 11.8 per cent. The brokerage has set a price target of 180, implying an upside of about 12 per cent from current levels. Jefferies expects Groww's earnings per share to grow at a compounded annual rate of 35 per cent between financial year 2026 (FY26) and FY28, driven by steady growth in the core broking business, expansion in new revenue streams, such as margin trading facility and wealth management, and margin expansion of around 700 basis points from FY26 levels. BS REPORTER

Lower fees expected to boost business even as assets under mgmt rise

Date: 21-12-2025, Publication: [The Financial Express](#), Journalist / Agency: , Edition: [Chennai](#), Supplement: , Page No:

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decision to sell a stake in the AMC in the IPO has come after remaining invested in the business since 1998. “They are monetising a part of their investment after 27 years and are selling only a portion,” he said. ICICI Bank will continue to be the majority shareholder of the firm with a 53% stake in the joint venture, said Shah. BUSINESS STRATEGY ICICI Prudential’s focus on hybrid products has made it one of the biggest asset managers in the category. Its market share in the hybrid category is around 25% compared to 13.6% in equity assets and 13.6% overall. “Our strength in hybrid and asset allocation-oriented strategies, has been built over multiple market cycles by focusing on risk-adjusted returns,” said Shah. It is also sharpening its focus on the alternative investment business including equity-focused Portfolio Management Services (PMS), Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), private credit, and office yield funds. Shah said between FY23 and FY25, alternative AUM has registered a compounded annual growth rate of 43.3%. Currently mutual funds account for 93% of its assets while alternatives account for the balance 7%.
